

COLORADO FIELD ORNITHOLOGISTS - SIGHT RECORD FORM

NEW STATE RECORD ☐UNUSUAL RECORD ☒A

Please print or type. Attach photographs and additional pages if necessary.

Species: Purple Finch | Carpodacus purpureus

(Vernacular Name)

(Scientific Name)

Date(s): January 11, 1985Number of birds seen: One Sex: Female Plumage: AdultLocality: 1041 Field Street Elevation: 5500 feetNearest town: Lakewood, Colorado County: JeffersonTime(s) observed: Approximately 8:00 a.m.Duration of observation (e.g. 1 sec., 5 min., etc.) Approximately 15 minutes

Other observers who saw the bird with you (give names, addresses, telephone numbers):

Joyce W. Cooper1041 Field St.Lakewood, CO 80215Telephone 237-4855

Other observers who saw the bird independently (give names, addresses, telephone numbers):

None to my knowledge

Light conditions (position of bird to light and shade, direction and strength of light):

Bird in bright sunshine on bird feeder just north of kitchen windowOptical equipment used (e.g. power, types): 9X36 Bushnell Custom BinocularsDistance, and how measured: Less than 30 feet from observers inside houseIf photographed, type of equipment and film: Not photographedWho else photographed the bird? None to my knowledge

Describe the bird's behavior (e.g. flying, feeding, or habits used in identifying):

Bird moved about on feeder showing all sides and leisurely picking up grain. No other birds present.

Describe in detail the bird's relative size, overall shape, plumage and color pattern. Include details of bill, wing and tail shape. Give particular emphasis to marks you used to identify the bird. Reference to its resemblance to field guide descriptions and illustrations is not enough. Describe only what you actually observed in the field:

Chunky finch about the size of a House Finch but with larger head and shorter notched tail. Upper parts brownish black with narrow white streaks on crown, back, and feather edges of wings. White on chin and in conspicuous white border on sides and back of triangular ear patch. Broad black streaks on breast and belly formed by lines of arrow-head shaped black marks as shown on female purpureus ~~as~~ illustrated in the National Geographical Society bird guide, page 441. Undertail coverts completely white insofar as visible.

Description, (continued)

Describe the bird's song and call, if given, including method of delivery, (i.e. from perch, in flight, duration): No song or other vocalization

Describe the general and specific habitat in which you observed the bird:

Bird feeder in suburban area near irrigation ditch and large old homestead

How did you eliminate similarly appearing species?

Chunky shape, distinctive face pattern, breast markings and white undertail coverts.

What is your prior experience with this and similarly appearing species?

My life list includes purple finch records from: N.H., Vt., N.Y., Va., ARK, Mich., Mo., Okl., Tex., Colo., Calif., and Canada.

List books, illustrations, recordings, other birders, etc. consulted and how this influenced your identification:

a) at time of observation: National Geographic and Peterson field guides.

b) after observation: 4 field guides and 5 books.

This report was written from notes made ^{immediately after observation} ~~during~~ ~~xxxx~~ ~~after~~ ~~xxxx~~ ~~observation~~ ~~from memory~~ ~~xxxx~~.

Date and time report was written: March 27, 1985 (from detailed notes made Jan. 11, 1985)

Reporting observer: John R. Cooper Signature: John R. Cooper

Address: 1041 Field St., Lakewood CO, 80215

Telephone 237-4855

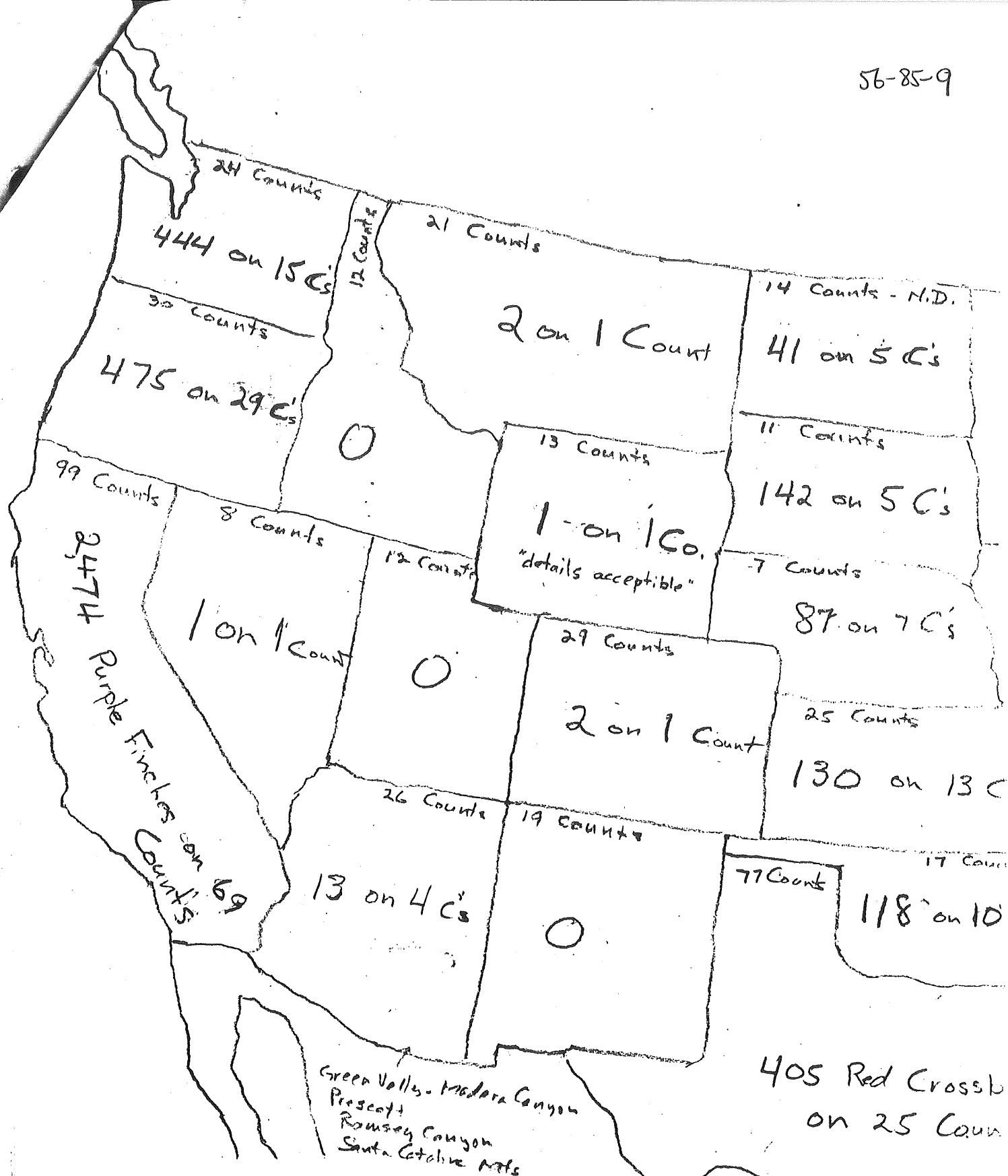
All reports will be maintained permanently at the address below.

Return to: CURATOR, DEPARTMENT OF ZOOLOGICAL COLLECTIONS
DENVER MUSEUM OF NATURAL HISTORY,
CITY PARK
DENVER, COLORADO 80205

See enclosed summary of Purple Finches counted in western states on 1980 Christmas Counts.

JRC

56-85-9



Number of Purple Finches reported
on 1984 Audubon Christmas
Bird Counts

John P. Berger
Feb 2, 1985